

Zimbabwe



Area 150,804 sq miles
(390,580 sq km)
Population 12.8 million
Capital Harare
Currency Various foreign
currencies in circulation
Official language English
Life expectancy 43 years



Zimbabwe is situated in southern Africa. The Zambezi River—on which lies the region's most spectacular natural feature, Victoria Falls—flows along its border with Zambia. Since its independence from Britain in 1980, Zimbabwe has been under the leadership of Robert Mugabe. The two main ethnic groups living here are the majority Shona in the north and the Ndebele in the south.

Botswana



Area 231,804 sq miles
(600,370 sq km)
Population 2 million
Capital Gaborone
Currency Pula
Official language English
Life expectancy 50 years



Botswana is an arid, landlocked nation, with the Kalahari Desert occupying its western side. Nearly 80 percent of the people belong to the Tswana ethnicity. A multiparty democracy, Botswana is one of the most politically stable countries in Africa. Botswana is one of the world's top producers of diamonds. Its wildlife safaris are a major tourist attraction.

Lesotho



Area 11,720 sq miles
(30,355 sq km)
Population 2.2 million
Capital Maseru
Currency Maloti
Official languages English
and Sesotho
Life expectancy 43 years



The Kingdom of Lesotho is a mountainous country. It is entirely surrounded by South Africa; thousands of Lesotho people find employment in South Africa's gold mines. The majority of its people belong to the Sotho ethnicity, though there is a small community of European origin as well as an Asian minority. Textile export is an important revenue source for Lesotho.

Namibia



Area 318,696 sq miles
(825,418 sq km)
Population 2.3 million
Capital Windhoek
Currency Namibian dollar
Official language English
Life expectancy 52 years



Namibia is a large country lying in southwest Africa. After many years of struggle, Namibia won independence from South Africa in 1990. The largest ethnic group, the Ovambo, mostly live in the far north. Namibia's original inhabitants, the San and Khoi (once called Bushmen), now

make up a small minority. Namibia is one of Africa's leading mineral producers, with abundant uranium and lead reserves. The country is covered in the vast expanses of the unspoiled Namib and Kalahari deserts, where wildlife such as the African elephant and black rhinoceros can be found.

